

THE CAUSES OF DIFFERENCES AMONG PLANTS

CLIMATE AND VEGETATION

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Andreas Schimper (1856–1901)

BEFORE

1737 Carl Linnaeus's *Flora Lapponica* includes details of the geographical distribution of Lapland plants.

1807 Alexander von Humboldt publishes his seminal *Essay on the Geography of Plants*.

AFTER

1916 In *Plant Succession: an Analysis of the Development of Vegetation*, Frederic Clements describes how communities of species are indicators of the climate in which they have matured.

1968 "The Role of Climate in the Distribution of Vegetation," by American geographers John Mather and Gary Yoshioka, explains how temperature and rainfall alone are not enough to define plant distributions.

That different plants grow in different climates was likely common knowledge for as long as agriculture has existed; many cultures have traded plants for thousands of years. However, the clear link between a region's dominant vegetation type and climate was not categorically spelled out until